

The Next Cigar

VOL. II · WEEKEND EDITION

WHAT WAS BUILT, WHAT WAS FOUND, WHAT IS OWED

PUBLISHED FROM SWEDEN

Thirty-one hours, twenty-two commits, *and four things that were quietly broken.*

A picture-first account of a weekend's work on thenextcigar.com. The site is in materially better shape than it was on Friday; three of the fixes were to faults that could have cost real money.

22

COMMITTS

All pushed or ready to push. Every one reversible.

4

FAULTS FOUND LIVE

Shop could take money and tell nobody. Ten archived products still sellable. No returns policy. Affiliate tag confusion.

3

ASSOCIATES PROGRAMMES

US, UK and Sweden, all approved the same evening.

3

NEW TOOLS ON THE FINDER

Landed-cost ranking, 90-day-low signal, first-visit nudge.

The front page, as it stands

THENEXTCIGAR.COM

FRIDAY 11 SEPTEMBER 2026 · MALMÖ · LISBON

Cohiba Robustos €1,990 Noblego sold out

Montecristo No. 4 CHF 420 Cigarmust live

Partagás D No. 4 €332.50

FREE TO READ · 20 RETAILERS · 133 LIVE PRICES

The Next Cigar

The anthology of the leaf – Cuban cigars, the European market, and the things worth owning.

VOL. II · NO. 09

INDEPENDENT · READER-SUPPORTED · NO TOBACCO SOLD HERE

PUBLISHED FROM SWEDEN

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Markets · box prices, live

THE FINDER →

VITOLA · BOX OF 25

CHEAPEST

Montecristo No. 4 CIGARMUST · CH

CHF 420 live · 10 Sep

Partagás Serie D No. 4 SIGARI E TABACCHI · IT

€332.50 checked 10 Sep

Hoyo de Monterrey Epicure No. 2 NOBLEGO · DE

€499.55 live · 10 Sep

Romeo y Julieta Petit Coronas HAVANA HOUSE · UK

£215 checked 15 May

Bolívar Belicosos Finos SAUTTER · UK

£575 checked 15 May

Trinidad Reyes · box of 12 CIGARMUST · CH

CHF 412.80 live · ▼10%

Cohiba Siglo VI

€1,850

MARKETS · REPORT

Where a box of Cohiba Behike 52 is cheapest in Europe – and why the answer changes by the week

Two retailers, two currencies, one duty question. The Finder now re-reads twenty shops four times a day; this is what the board said this morning.

Accessories · tested

ALL REVIEWS →

The best cigar cutters of 2026

Five worth owning · guillotine, V, multi-tool

Torch lighters: single jet or double?

Five tested · and why we don't ship them by air

Gifts under \$100 that actually get used

Hygrometers, cedar spills, a French ashtray

Your humidor will betray you this summer

Two-way packs, and the reading that matters

The board now answers the question people actually have: *what will this cost at my door?*

Every general duty calculator on the internet models customs and VAT and ignores tobacco excise — which for cigars is most of the bill. The Finder already had a correct landed-cost function, wired into 52 detail pages and not into the board that carries the traffic. Now it is.

The board · 51 vitolas, delivered to Sweden22 BRANDS

SHIP IT TO

Sweden

ranked by landed cost to Sweden. 34 of 51 rows are not where the sticker price put them — excise and VAT do not respect a price list.

OLA	CHEAPEST AT	AT YOUR DOOR	P
José L. Piedra Brevas BOX OF 25 · BREVAS	EGM Cigars CH · LIVE · 13 SEPT	€179	€
Quintero Brevas BOX OF 25 · BREVAS	EGM Cigars CH · LIVE · 13 SEPT	€180	€
Meo y Julieta Petit Coronas	LCDH Brussel (Charlemagne) BE · CHECKED 15 MAY	€311	€1
Alvar Petit Coronas	Noblego DE · CHECKED 15 MAY	€349	€1

Ship it to · Sweden. The board re-ranks by delivered cost. Figures in oxblood are landed, not listed. The hint says how many rows moved — measured by rank, so ties do not count.

At your door · cheapest to Sweden: Noblego

Listed price at Noblego	€440	Estimate. Excise is worked out on 12.7 g per cigar (from the vitola's ring and length) and on the price paid; VAT is charged on price, duty and excise together. Border parcels are assessed by customs — this is what the law says they should charge, not a promise of what your carrier will do.
Excise (per cigar)	€4	
VAT 25%	€111	
At your door · box of 25	€555	
Per cigar	€22.20	

Rates: Skatteverket — Skattesatser för tobak, in force from 2026-01-01. Checked 11 September 2026

The bill, on a detail page. Listed price, excise per cigar, VAT, total, per cigar — with the rate's source and date. Same function, same numbers.

34

OF 51 ROWS
MOVE ·
SWEDEN

41

OF 51 ROWS
MOVE ·
GERMANY

96%

SPREAD, ONE
BOX

José L. Piedra Brevas, live today: €168 landed in DE, €179 in SE, €227 in FI, €330 in the UK.

The board · 51 vitolas, cheapest listing22 BRANDS

New here? Pick where you live and the board re-prices every box to your door — duty, tobacco excise and VAT included. The cheapest listing is often not the cheapest box.

SHIP IT TO

— nowhere yet, show listed prices —

Not a tour. One sentence, shown once to a stranger, gone for good after a dismissal or a choice. Readers arrive from Google. The next cigar week edition would reach nobody.

The board · 51 vitolas, delivered to Finland22 BRANDS

SHIP IT TO

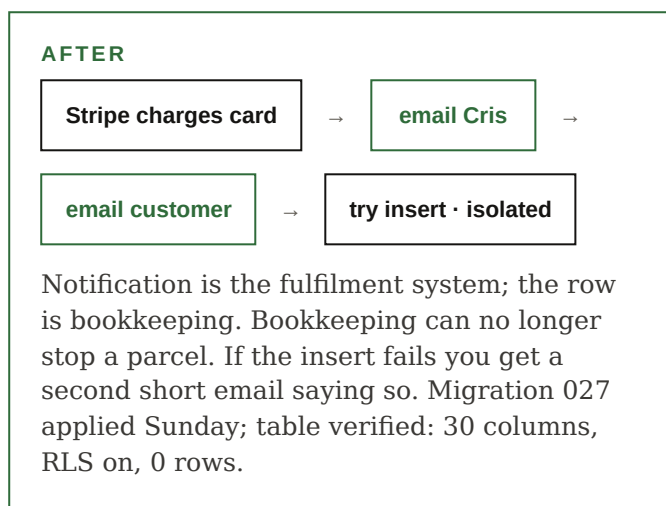
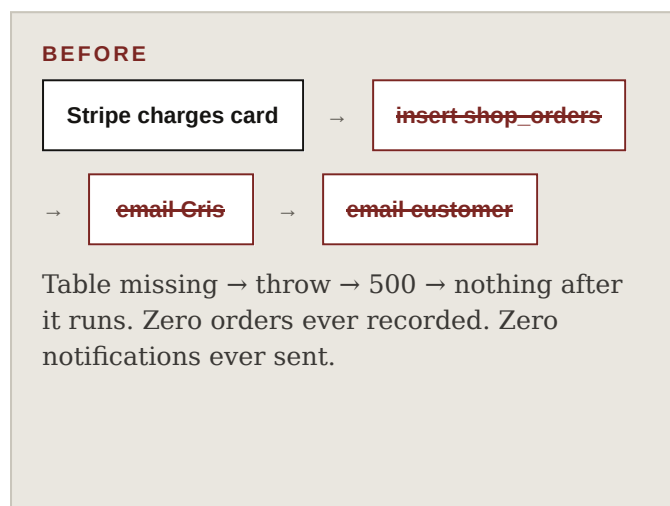
Finland

Re-ranked by landed cost to Finland. 28 of 51 rows are not where the sticker price put them — excise and VAT do not respect a price list.

390 px. Same board, same selector, delivered to Finland. Nothing scrolls sideways.

The shop could take a customer's money *and tell nobody.*

The order webhook wrote to a database table before sending any email. The table did not exist — migration 027 was written and never applied. So the insert threw, the function returned 500, and neither you nor the customer was ever told. Stripe kept the money and retried, failing identically, for as long as it liked.



Three more things the shop did not have

ALL FIXED

10

ARCHIVED PRODUCTS STILL SELLABLE

The catalogue builder read `isArchived` and never filtered on it. A hoodie with no supplier was purchasable by POSTing its slug. 26 → 14 live.

0

RETURNS POLICIES

Terms said returns "follow the policy displayed at checkout." Nothing was displayed at checkout. EU distance selling requires 14 days, stated before the sale. Now `/shipping-and-returns/`, linked from footer, terms and every buy button; schema carries it.

5

PRODUCT PAGES INVENTING SPECS

"440-grade steel," "aluminium tube inserts with O-ring seals" — on a cedar-lined pouch with no tubes. Rewritten from what the listing and 90–300 verified buyers actually say, including the bad tags.

The buying guides now point at the shop they belong to

71 AMAZON LINKS · 0 SHOP LINKS → 17 ADDED

Each guide opens its shop section by declaring the conflict — *we earn far more when you buy from us* — then concedes where Amazon wins: under \$30, or when you want a lifetime warranty from a company with a repair department. A guide that tells you when not to buy from it reads as advice, not an advert.

Three programmes in one evening — and the links were *never* paying a stranger.

Fifty-eight links carried a tag Amazon refused at signup; sixteen more were short links carrying a second tag. Both turned out to be yours, on an account you had forgotten, with \$33.69 already in it. Reverted to the original ID so the reporting stays continuous.

STORE	TAG	STATUS	CLICKS / QUARTER
amazon.com	thenextcigar-20	Original, earning since August. Primary store. Tax interview blocked on citizenship dropdown — with Amazon support.	660
amazon.co.uk	thenextciga0a-21	Approved Saturday. Payment method set (Revolut, LT IBAN).	329
amazon.se	thenextcigar-21	Approved Saturday.	69
amazon.de	—	One click from the UK confirmation page. Not yet taken.	65

Disclosure now uses Amazon's required sentence verbatim, above the links. Buy box renders for the first time: Xikar Xi1, Colibri V-Cut, Case Elegance on cutters; Xikar ELX on lighters — the branded tier you cannot source, so nothing competes with your own shelf. UK and SE tags earn nothing until OneLink is configured.

Retailers — the revenue you are not collecting

HALFWHEEL'S ENTIRE BUSINESS MODEL

SUNDAY, 13 SEPTEMBER 2026 · MALMO · 49 EGM Cigars live · Montecristo Double Edmundo CHF 399.2 · FREE TO READ · 21 RETAILERS · 143 LIVE PRICES

The Next Cigar

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Front page · Markets · Magazine · The Lounge · Shop · Diary · Watch · Tools · Sign in · join · free

FRONT PAGE · MAGAZINE · CUBANS

Where to Buy Cuban Cigars in Europe — the 2026 Retailer Map

We mapped every Cuban cigar retailer worth knowing across 18 European countries — from Sweden's Cigarspecialisten to Switzerland's Cigarmust and the UK's James J. Fox. Here's the full list, plus where you can actually compare prices.

By Cristian Ortiz Suárez · 22 May 2026 · 12 min read

Your most-read page. 297 clicks a quarter on *Where to buy Cuban cigars in Europe*. Every retailer on it wants those readers. None runs an affiliate programme; all of them can buy an advert.

SHIPPED THIS WEEKEND

Outbound click counter. One listener in the layout, 27 retailer domains, aggregate only — no IP, no cookie, no id. A row is (day, host, page) and an integer. Verified in a browser: Noblego click fires one beacon, Turmeaus fires none; each of eight retailers on the map article fires exactly one. Needs migration 031 applied.

Five letters drafted. Noblego, Cigarworld, Cigarmust, EGM, Sigari e Tabacchi. €120 a month, three months, a labelled slot sold *around* the board and never in it. Send once the counter has a month in it.

Everything that is still open, *in the order it matters.*

Yours

CRIS

- **Push.** Three commits waiting on git push.
- **Apply migration 031** (retailer clicks) in the Supabase SQL editor, same as 027.
- **Run the history cleanup** — docs/sql/history-cleanup-2026-09-13.sql, step 1, read it, step 2. Report the count.
- **Check Stripe.** Only place that knows whether the broken webhook ever swallowed a real order.
- **Buy the four test products** — case, four-tube case, torch, jet-with-V-cutter. About 800 kr.
- **Amazon support** on the citizenship dropdown; keep the answer in writing. Do not use anyone else's name.
- **Rotate ADMIN_PASSWORD.** It appeared in a screenshot earlier in this project.
- **Amazon.de** — one click, 65 clicks a quarter.

Mine, when you say

CLAUDE

- **Flip HIGH_SIGNAL_ENABLED** once the history is clean — the "above usual" tag is written and waiting.
- **OneLink script** in the layout, so UK and Swedish readers land on their own store and the tags actually pay.
- **Product photographs in** when the parcels land; supplier images out.
- **The 46 people** — 15 in MailerLite, 31 in the Lounge — merged into one list, then one honest email.
- **Parsers** for CigarOne and Turmeaus; the 37 dead product URLs; geocode the Lounge map.
- **Terms page** still says 21+, inherited from a US template.

The one sentence

You are not a review site and would lose as one. You are the place people go to work out **where to buy, what it will really cost, and whether it is genuine** — and this weekend the site got materially better at all three.